

Improvement Roadmap & Recommendations

Prepared for executive review — priorities and suggested next steps

The committee/document portal is now functional: categories (AGM, HR, Finance, Audit, Procurement, and any future committee) are fully dynamic and managed from one admin screen, and both PDF text search and OCR search on scanned pages work across all categories automatically. The recommendations below outline what would take this from a working internal tool to a production-grade system, ordered by priority.

1. Production Readiness

PRIORITY — RECOMMENDED BEFORE WIDER ROLLOUT

The application currently runs in Django's development mode, which is not intended for real use beyond a single developer's machine.

- **Disable debug mode** — Turn off Django's debug error pages before any wider access; they currently expose file paths, database queries, and internal settings to anyone who hits an error.
- **Secure configuration** — Move the secret key and any passwords out of the settings file and into environment variables, separate from the codebase.
- **Real web server** — Serve the application through a production web server (e.g. Gunicorn or Waitress behind Nginx) instead of the built-in development server.
- **Upgrade the database** — SQLite is fine for testing but is not built for several people writing data at the same time. Move to PostgreSQL before rolling this out beyond a small pilot group.
- **Backups** — Set up automated, scheduled backups of the database and the uploaded documents folder. Right now, a lost or corrupted database file means lost board records.
- **HTTPS** — Required if the portal will be reachable outside a fully trusted internal network.

2. Governance & Compliance Features

HIGH VALUE — MATCHES THE PURPOSE OF THIS SYSTEM

Since this system holds board and committee records, these features tend to matter most to leadership and to auditors.

- **Document access audit trail** — Track who viewed or downloaded which meeting minutes, and when — not just who uploaded them. The system already logs some activity internally; the next step is a readable report for admins.
- **Approval workflow for minutes** — A visible status (Draft → Reviewed → Approved) instead of a PDF simply appearing once uploaded.

- **Action item tracking** — Capture decisions and action items from a meeting, assign an owner and a due date, and track status, so agreed actions are not lost in a PDF.

3. Everyday Usability

MEDIUM PRIORITY — DRIVES DAILY ADOPTION

- **Email notifications** — Alert users when a new meeting/document is uploaded to a committee they belong to, or before an upcoming meeting.
- **Role-based permissions** — Reusable roles such as Committee Member, Committee Chair, and Admin, instead of granting access one screen at a time per user. The permission system is already dynamic per category, so this is a natural extension rather than a rebuild.
- **Homepage summary stats** — Surface figures such as meetings this month or pending approvals on the homepage, giving executives a reason to check in regularly rather than only when searching for something specific.
- **Mobile-friendly polish** — Board members frequently check documents from a phone; a pass on responsive layout would help here.

4. Longer-Term Enhancements

NICE TO HAVE — CONSIDER AFTER THE ABOVE

- **E-signatures** — Allow resolutions and minutes to be formally signed off within the portal.
- **Calendar integration** — A calendar view of upcoming meetings, with iCal export to personal calendars.
- **Document versioning** — Keep prior versions when a PDF is re-uploaded, instead of overwriting the previous file.

Suggested next step: confirm priorities from Sections 1 and 2 first, since these address security and governance risk directly, then schedule Section 3 items for the following release.